AA-O-00240/5C(GSA-FSS)
September 8, 1970
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. AA-O-00240/5B(GSA-FSS)
April 7, 1967
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. AA-O-240
February 2, 1961

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FOR

TOP ASSEMBLY, DESK, AND SUPPORT PANELS,

STEEL, UNITIZED

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Standardization Division, Washington, D. C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification AA-O-240, dated February 2, 1961.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers top assemblies which are designed for use over one or two uninsulated security filing cabinets to form a desk (see 6.1). This specification covers the detailed requirements for the top assembly and support panels; the general requirements and other information pertaining to the top assemblies will be found in AA-O-00240, Office Furniture, Steel, Unitized (General Specification) (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and sizes. The items shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Top assembly, desk 66 inches wide, 30 inches deep, for use over two 2-drawer security filing cabinets.

Type II - Top assembly, desk, 50 inches wide, 30 inches deep, for use over one 2-drawer security filing cabinet.

Type III - Support panel, desk top, for use with Type II desk top assembly.

Size 17 inches wide - For use with L-unit desk attachments.
Size 29 inches wide - For use as free-standing desks.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

AA-O-00240 - Office Furniture, Steel, Unitized.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-97 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade) and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standard:

Federal Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

FSC 7110

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-T-6841 - Tape, Adhesive, Rubber and Cork Composition.

Miltary Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

National Classification Board:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies may be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., ATTN: Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, D. C. 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies may be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 202 Union Station, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, the requirements of 3.1 of AA-O-00240 shall apply.

3.2 Material. The material used in the construction of the top assembly and support panels shall b of the kind and quality specified in 3.2 of AA-O-00240 and as specified herein. The paragraph numbers of the materials used in the construction are listed in table I.

TABLE I. Material references

AA-O-00240 paragraph numbers	Material
3.2.1	Steel
3.2.2	Linoleum
3.2.3	Plastic laminate sheet
3.2.4	Finishing materials
3.2.4.1	Primer
3.2.4.2	Enamel
3.2.4.3	Zinc coating
3.2.4.4	Cadmium plating

3.3 Construction. The construction details of the top assembly and support panels shall be specified in the applicable paragraphs of AA-O-00240 and as specified herein. The paragraph numbers of the construction details are listed in table II.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table II - Construction references

AA-O-00240 Paragraph Numbers	Construction
3.3.1	Spot welding
3.3.2	Definition of terms
3.3.2.1	Welding terms
3.3.2.2	Fabricating terms
3.3.4	Color
3.3.4.1	Metal finish
3.3.4.2	Linoleum
3.3.4.3	Plastic laminate sheet
3.3.5	Tolerances
3.3.6	Assembly
3.3.7	Top construction
3.3.7.1	Top plate and edge molding
3.3.7.2	Binding strip
3.3.7.3	Linoleum top covering
3.3.7.4	Plastic laminate top covering. When specified in invitation for bids.
3.3.7.4.1	Control samples for plastic covered tops.

3.3.8 Design. The top assembly shall be in accordance with Figure 1 and Figure 2 and as specified herein. The items shall withstand the tests specified in 4.4 of this specification. The Type I and Type II top assemblies are designed for use over Size 1, Class 3 and Class 6 uninsulated security cabinets which are constructed in accordance with Federal Specification AA-F-358, Filing Cabinet, Steel, Legal and Letter Size, Uninsulated, Security. The outside overall dimensions of the Size I cabinets are 29-13/16 inches maximum width, 28 inches maximum depth and 30-5/8 inches maximum height.

3.3.9 Type I desk top assembly. For use over two 2-drawer security filing cabinets. The design and dimensions shall be as shown in Figure 1. The top size shall be 66 inches wide and 30 inches deep. The assembly shall consist of a top, a center drawer, and two underside frames. The center drawer shall be located in the space between the frames. The minimum inside dimensions of the drawer shall be 2-1/2 inches high, 15-7/8 inches wide and 18-1/16 inches deep. A lock is not required.

3.3.9.1 Underside frames. The underside of the top shall be fitted with two frames as shown in Figure 1 (The frames are to fit over, but not be attached to, the security filing cabinets). The frames shall be constructed of 1/2 inch by 1 inch by 0.060 inch angle steel or alternatively frame may be a 1/2 inch by 1 inch 16 gage (0.0598 inch) steel formed angle. The one inch dimension of the angle shall be attached to the top by means of at least 4 oval head sheet metal screws. To prevent scratching or damaging the finish of the filing cabinet, the inside angles of the frame shall be lined with cork and rubber cushioning material in accordance with Specification MIL-T-6641 and shall have pressure sensitive adhesive backing and shall be not less than 1/32 inch thick. Alternatively, the inside angles of the frame may be fitted with nylon buttons or glides.

3.3.9.2 Center drawer. The drawer front shall be of double wall construction unless the convenience tray forms the inner wall. The outside drawer front shall be not less than 20 gage (0.0359 inch) steel. The top edge of the outside front shall be formed in a return flange to receive the inside drawer front or convenience tray. The side and bottom edges shall be formed in a return flange and an additional 90 degree flange to provide for welding to the drawer body by not less than 2 spot welds to each side and 4 spot welds to the bottom. (See Figure 2). The inside drawer front shall be not less than 26 gage (0.0179 inch) steel. The four edges of the inside drawer front shall be formed in a flange or offset formation to fit into the outside drawer front and shall be held in place by spot welding. The four corners shall be neatly closed with no sharp edges and the top corners brazed and ground smooth. The center drawer body shall be not less than 24 gage (0.0239 inch) steel. The top edge of the drawer

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.11.2 Height adjustment mechanism. The height adjustment mechanism shall permit continuous height adjustment over a range of 1-5/8 inches minimum and shall be entirely operable by hand. The height adjustment mechanism shall consist of a metal tube having a diameter of at least 1-1/2 inches with a 3/8 inch 16-threaded stem. The bearing surface of the tube shall be fully closed and smooth. The tube and stem shall operate with a threaded nut incorporated in a support constructed of not less than 16 gage (0.0478 inch) steel. The tube and threaded stem shall be made corrosion resistant by cadmium plating in accordance with 3.2.4.4. The support may be zinc or cadmium plated in accordance with 3.2.4.3 or 3.2.4.4, or enameled in accordance with 3.4, 3.4.1, 3.4.2 and 3.4.3 of AA-O-00240. The height adjustment mechanism shall be constructed and attached to the end panel in a manner to prevent loosening or instability.

3.3.11.3 Top edge cushioning. The Size 17 inch support panel shall be supplied with two discs of cork and rubber cushioning material in accordance with MIL-T-6841 and shall have pressure sensitive adhesive backing. The disc shall have a minimum diameter of 1-1/4 inches and shall be 1/8 inch thick. The discs may be adhered to the upper portion of the support panel.

3.4 Pretreatment and finishing. Shall be in accordance with 3.4, 3.4.1, 3.4.2, and 3.4.3 and 3.4.4 of AA-O-00240.

3.5 Identification marking. Shall be in accordance with 3.5 of AA-O-00240.

3.6 Workmanship. Shall be in accordance with 3.6 of AA-O-00240.

3.7 Assembly instructions. The supplier shall furnish printed assembly instructions with each Type II desk top assembly. The text of these instructions shall be submitted for approval of the contracting officer.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. The requirements of Section 4 of AA-O-00240 and as specified herein shall apply.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination. Examination of the top assemblies and support panels shall be in accordance with the classification of defects and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for general requirements shown in Table II of AA-O-00240 and for specific requirements in Table III shown herein. The lot size shall be expressed in units of top assemblies and/or support panels for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one complete top assembly and support panel.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Underside frames	Less than minimum gage specified	X	
	Not lined as specified	X	
	Not located as specified		X
Center drawer	Components less than minimum gages specified	X	
	Not flanged, channeled, folded or beaded		X
	Tray not as specified		X
Drawer suspensions	Less than minimum gages specified	X	
	Horizontal movement of drawer after attachment to top		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Classification of defects (con.)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Drawer stops	Do not prevent drawer from falling out		X
	Not equipped with bumpers		X
Support panel	Components less than minimum gages specified	X	
	Sharp edges at bottom	X	
	Not securely attached to top		X
Height adjustment mechanism	Not continuous adjustment over full range		X
	Not finished as specified		X
	Not operable by hand		X
Top edge cushioning	Cushioning discs not provided		X
	Discs not properly located		X

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. Inspection will be made of desk top assemblies and support panels for compliance with dimensions specified including thickness of metal and film thickness of enamel. Any dimensions not within tolerance specified shall be classified as a defect.

4.2.2.3 Inspection levels and AQL's. The inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units, shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and shall be as follows:

	Inspection levels	AQL's
For examination in Table III Major	I	4.0
For examination in Table III Total	I	10.0
For examination in 4.2.2.2 (one class)	I	4.0

4.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in Section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with Table IV. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed in Table IV shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be I of MIL-STD-105 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Tests. Tests specified in 4.5.6, 4.5.7, 4.5.8, 4.5.9 and 4.5.10 of AA-O-00240 shall apply.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I or II, top assembly . The drawer of each type I or II top assembly shall be secured with tape conforming to PPP-T-97. Each top assembly shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Fiberboard die-cuts or built-up pads with the fiberboard meeting the requirements of PPP-F-320 shall be utilized as cushioning and blocking. The box shall be closed, waterproofed sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.2 Type III, support panels. Each support panel shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Fiberboard die-cuts or built-up pads with the fiberboard meeting the requirements of PPP-F-320 shall be utilized as cushioning and blocking. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I or II, top assembly. The drawer of each type I or II top assembly shall be secured with tape conforming to PPP-T-97. Each top assembly shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming PPP-B-636, class domestic. Fiberboard die-cuts or built-up pads with the fiberboard meeting the requirements of PPP-F-320 shall be utilized as cushioning and blocking. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2.2 Type III, support panels. Each support panel shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Fiberboard die-cuts or built-up pads with the fiberboard meeting the requirements of PPP-F-320 shall be utilized as cushioning and blocking. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The top assemblies or support panels shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Mil. Std. 129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. When the top assembly is used over two security filing cabinets, the filing cabinets form the pedestals. When the top assembly is used over one security filing cabinet, a 29 inch wide end panel can be added to the opposite end to form a single pedestal desk. A 17 inch wide end panel can be used when the desk top assembly and one security filing cabinet is to be used with an L-unit desk attachment. The dimensions of the top assembly permit use only with the security filing cabinets constructed in accordance with Size 1 of Federal Specification AA-F-358.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, symbol and date of this specification.

(b) Types and sizes desired (see 1.2.1).

(c) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).

(d) Whether plastic tops are required (see Table II, 3.3.8.4).

(e) Selection of applicable levels of packing (see 5.1).

(f) Marking requirements (see 5.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

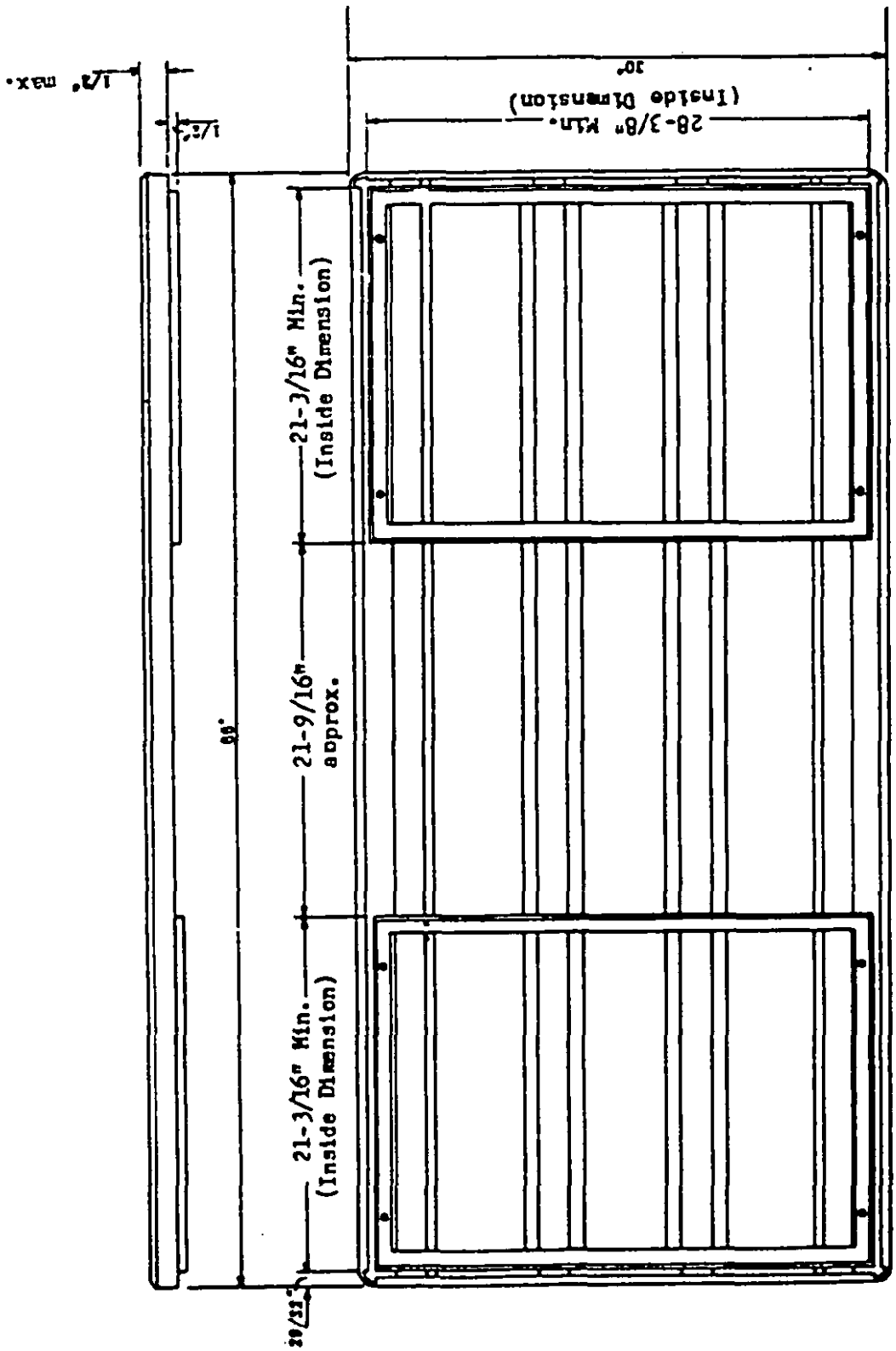


Figure 1 - Type I - Top Assembly, Desk

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

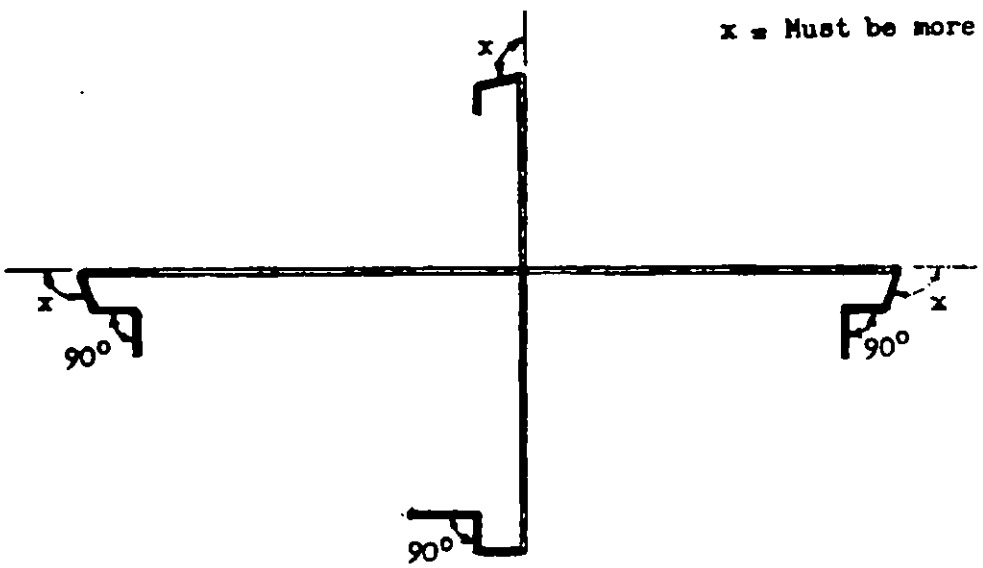


Figure 2 - Outside Drawer Front
(Horizontal and Vertical Sections)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION · FEDERAL SUPPLY SERVICE

SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, and mail to: General Services Administration, FSS (FMSP), Wash. D. C. 20406.

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION

AA-O-00240/5C(GSA-FSS) Top Assembly, Desk, and Support Panels Steel, Unitized

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(Include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

FORM GSA FLD 69 2200

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.